beyond established relationships. Its search for global solutions leads it to contemplate a new form of plurilateralism.

The second big driver of the changes we see around us is, of course, the growth of Chinese power. There are three autonomous aspects to this phenomenon that need considered analysis. The first is the enormous expansion of Chinese capabilities in virtually every field. The second is a projection pattern that changed beginning with 2009 and, more vigorously, after 2012. The third, and this was particularly apparent during the pandemic, is China's deep relevance to the global economy. These trends obviously cannot be viewed in isolation and must also be seen in terms of their implications for others. They have propelled global economic and strategic rebalancing, that too in a radical manner.

The US, as the dominant power of the day, is the most affected on both scores. Equally, the changes have had an influence on the rules and practices of the current order, management of the global commons and on the nature of world politics itself. None of that is surprising given that the combined import of these developments has been multiplied by their focussed leveraging for strategic purposes. That seamlessness exhibited abroad by China is a reflection of both a tightly integrated worldview and its domestic outlook.

So, let us be clear that this is not just about the rise of simply another power, however major. We have entered a new phase in international relations and the full impact of China's re-emergence will be felt more than those of major powers before it. And naturally, the reverberations are strongest in its immediate vicinity.

These developments centring on the US and China are largely responsible for the concept of the Indo-Pacific taking root so rapidly. They have fundamentally shaken the old order but not yet created a new one. The region has come to grudgingly appreciate that it can neither be insulated from their relationship nor indeed indifferent to what it portends for global goods. What this has in common with a very dissimilar situation in Europe a generation ago is that sharp geopolitical changes are redefining the very contours of the landscape. In Europe, it happened when American power was at its peak, encouraging a generosity that overcame the cautions of that continent's history. In the Indo-Pacific, it is a very different story, where it is the relative limitations of American abilities that has triggered a rethinking on the part of all parties.